The Line Across the Floor

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 10

Nib chose the longest scratch on the platform floor. If the window followed it, the lantern would point straight into the roof. Lark checked the guide. Its reference ran from the window post to a fixed floor peg, a much shorter line with a much more useful destination.

“A very long line,” Nib declared. “The right line,” Lark replied with quiet determination.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

zip

“Compare pin and pine,” Lark modeled clearly. “The final silent e helps i make its long sound in pine and line. The pronoun I is a whole word with that same long sound; it means the person speaking. We'll read it explicitly before using it.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try line, pine, time, I. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read line in the guide,” Lark invited gently. “Which line joins the two fixed points in its diagram?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I can see a pine. Sam can see a line.**

“What can Sam see?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence names him rather than the speaker?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib put his paw beside the fixed peg. Lark aligned the window frame to the matching reference. The intended path now led out toward the community meeting place, rather than into the roof. They secured the frame. When the shutter moved, a connecting ring rattled against its pin and stopped the motion short.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write line beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded the fixed peg as well as the line. Nib left the old scratches where they were. The window's direction was settled; the loose ring was now the one remaining reason the shutter could not move smoothly.